Extracting Array Data

It is often useful to extract array elements into individual scalar variables, which can be done easily in a single statement with PHP's `list` language construct.

With `list()`

```
$myArr = ['Alice', 'Bob', 'Russell'];

list ($first, $second) = $myArr;

var_dump($first);
var_dump($second);

Output:
string(5) "Alice"
string(3) "Bob"
```

With the `list` construct, PHP traverses the `$myArr` array starting at the first element and assigns a copy of the value (modifying `$first` does not affect the value in `$myArr` and so on) to each variable contained inside the parentheses in turn, until all variables have a value. Notice that I only got the first two elements from a three-element array. `list` will stop once its variables have values.

In the case of there being more variables to assign than elements available, PHP will generate a warning error: `PHP Warning: Undefined array key ...` but otherwise will continue to execute (and any variables without an assigned value will get the default value of `null`).

`list()` with Keys

Since PHP 7.1, `list` can contain keys, or square bracket array notation can be used instead:

```
$myArr1 = ['Alice', 'Rita', 'Sue', 'Bob'];
$myArr2 = [
    'lang' => 'PHP',
    'ver'  => '8.4',
];
```